INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SHEATH, PEN AND PENCIL, POCKET

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D. C. 20407, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward any recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sheaths for insertion in a pocket for carrying pens, pencils and the like (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The pocket sheaths shall be of the following types and styles, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Leather.
  Style A - One front and two back compartments.

Type II - Plastic.
  Style A - One front and two back compartments.
  Style B - One compartment.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Folding, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.
PPP-T-76 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper.

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-43014 - Boxes: Water Resistant Paperboard; Folding, Set-Up and Metal-Stayed.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material

3.1.1 Leather. The leather used in leather (Type I) sheaths shall be smooth finish, full or corrected grain, vegetable tanned cattlehide not less than 3/64 inch, minus 1/128 inch, in thickness and shall be devoid of cuts, damaged grain, open scratches, open grub holes, brands, hip marks, rough shoulders or other defects which affect appearance or serviceability.

3.1.2 Metal. The metal used in the spring clip of the Type I sheath shall be spring steel suitable to the purpose.

3.1.3 Thread. The thread used in stitching leather (Type I) sheaths shall be cotton or linen of such size and strength as to be suitable for stitching leather.

3.1.4 Plastic. Plastic used in Type II sheaths shall be transparent, translucent or opaque, flexible plastic not less than 0.016 inch thick. The finish may simulate linen or smooth grain leather. The plastic shall be non-injurious to personnal under normal usage and, when required by the procuring officer, a certificate to this effect shall be furnished by a commercial laboratory approved by the procuring officer. The plastic shall be nonflammable or flame resistant when tested as specified in 4.5.

3.2 Design. Type I and Type II sheaths shall be designed as specified in 3.2.1, 3.2.2 and 3.2.3.

3.2.1 Type I, Style A. Type I, Style A sheaths shall be so designed that there is one front and two back compartments. The front compartment shall extend the entire width of the sheath (exclusive of seams) and the top front shall be cut out 1/2 to one inch shorter than the rear wall of the front compartment. The two back compartments shall be formed by dividing the rear compartment vertically with a seam. The bottom front of the sheath shall have a pocket suitable for containing an identification card 2-3/4 inches wide by 1-1/8 inches high. The pocket shall have a window permitting viewing of the card while it is inserted in the pocket. The upper front of the sheath shall be equipped with a "U" shaped, leather covered, spring clip, one leg of which projects down the outside toward the bottom of the sheath thru a slit in the leather and the other leg is securely attached inside the front.

3.2.2 Type II, Style A. Type II, Style A plastic sheaths shall be of the same design as Type I, Style A, except that they shall have a plastic flap projecting from the top front toward the bottom in lieu of the spring clip and its covering.

3.2.3 Type II, Style B. Type II, Style B plastic sheaths shall consist of a single compartment the back of which extends above the front. A flap shall project from the top front toward the bottom.

3.3 Construction. The construction of Type I and Type II sheaths shall be as required by 3.3.1 and 3.3.2 and in conformance with the applicable design in 3.2.

3.3.1 Type I. The construction of Type I (Leather) sheaths shall consist of a single piece of leather folded and stitched to form the compartments specified in 3.2.1. The identification card pocket shall be stitched to the bottom front of the sheath.

The spring clip covering shall be stitched on that portion projecting through the sheath so that the clip is completely covered to prevent contact between the metal spring clip and the user's pocket. The leather clip fastening flap which is inside the front compartment shall be securely attached with a leather bonding agent or shall be stitched inside the front of the sheath.

All stitching shall be Stitch Type 301 in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 751, with not less than eight stitches per inch.

All edges shall be smooth and cleanly cut.

The identification card inserted in the front pocket shall be white card stock not less than 0.0080 inch thick and printed as shown herewith:

NAME _____

STREET _____

CITY _____ STATE _____

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3.3.2 Type 2 (Plastic).

3.3.2.1 Style A. The construction of the three-compartment sheaths shall be of plastic conforming to 3.1.4 and shall be in accordance with the design specified by 3.2.2. All seams shall be sealed by a high frequency electronic sealing method and shall be devoid of skips and gaps and shall not be crooked or other than of good appearance. The sheath shall be constructed of not more than four pieces of plastic with one piece each composing the front, back, divider between front and back compartments and the downward projecting front flap.

3.3.2.2 Style B. The construction of the one-compartment sheaths shall be in accordance with the requirements of 3.3.2.1 except that they shall be in accordance with the design specified in 3.2.3 and they shall be constructed of not more than three pieces of plastic, with one piece each composing the front, back and downward projecting front flap.

3.4 Dimensions. The dimensions of the sheaths shall be as shown in Table I.

Table I - Dimensions in Inches

	Type I Style A		Type II Style A		Type II Style B	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
Overall height	5½	5-3/4	5½	5-3/4	5½	5-3/4
Overall width	3-1/4	3½	3-1/4	3½	3-1/4	3½
Rear compartment widths	1-1/4	2	1-1/4	2	—	—
Spring clip						
Width	1/2	3/4	—	—	—	—
Length	2	2½	—	—	—	—
Identification card window						
Width	2-1/8	2-3/8	2-1/8	2-3/8	—	—
Height	7/8	1-1/8	7/8	1-1/8	—	—
Flap						
Width	—	—	2½	1-3/5	1-1/4	1-3/4
Height	—	—	1-1/4	1-3/4	1-1/4	1-3/4

3.5 Color

3.5.1 Type I. Type I sheaths shall be light tan color, unless otherwise specified. The entire outer surface shall be a uniform shade.

3.5.2 Type II. The Type II sheaths shall be white or colorless, unless otherwise specified. White sheaths may have a colorless front flap.

3.6 Finish. All components shall have a smooth finish without burrs, roughness or pits and the spring steel clip shall have a corrosion inhibiting phosphate coating.

3.7 Workmanship. The sheaths shall be free of flaws and defects which affect serviceability or appearance.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier's responsibility. Unless otherwise specified, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. (See 6.2.)

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all pen and pencil sheaths of the same type and style offered for delivery at the same time.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection. A random sample of pen and pencil sheaths shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level I, with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 6.5 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one pen and pencil sheath.

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4.2.3 Sampling for testing. For testing in accordance with 4.5, two plastic pen and pencil sheaths shall be selected at random from each sample of Type II sheaths selected in accordance with 4.2.2.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of contents the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. The inspection level shall be Level II and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in Table II. Any sheaths in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective sheaths in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II

Visual and Dimensional Defects

Not type and class specified.
Leather not quality specified.
Leather not thickness specified.
Metal not spring steel.
Metal not phosphate coated.
Thread not as required.
Plastic not flexible.
Plastic not thickness specified.
Design not as specified.
Spring clip not properly covered to prevent contact of metal with pocket.
Clip fastening flap not securely fastened.
Edges not smooth and cleanly cut.
Identification card not specified thickness.
Identification card not printed as specified.
Seams of plastic sheaths not properly sealed and devoid of skips and gaps.
Sheaths constructed of more than specified number of pieces of material.
Seams crooked or not of good appearance.
Dimensions not as specified.
Color not as specified.
Finish not devoid of burrs, pits or roughness.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with Table III. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery.

TABLE III.- Preparation for Delivery Defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

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4.5 Flammability test. The two specimens selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be required to meet the conditions relative to flammability, as specified in 3.1.4 and failure, by either specimen, to meet the requirements of 3.1.4 shall be considered cause for rejection of the entire lot.

In conducting the test a draft shield shall be used to reduce air current effects. Hold the specimen horizontally within the shield above a Bunsen burner having a 1-inch to 1-1/4-inch blue flame just touching the edge of the sheath until the specimen ignites, or for a period of not over 30 seconds. Remove from the flame. If the specimen burns when in contact with the flame but will not continue to burn when removed from the flame, it is flame resistant.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102).

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I. Each sheath shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to MIL-B-43014. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Type II. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) 24 sheaths shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to MIL-B-43014. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I. Each sheath shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed with tape conforming to PPP-T-76.

5.1.2.2 Type II. Twenty-four sheaths shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed with tape conforming to PPP-T-76.

5.1.3 Level C. The sheaths shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practive.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Sheaths of like description packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3, PPP-B-591, class II, PPP-B-601, type II, class 2, grade A. The fiberboard boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight of the triple wall fiberboard box and the wood boxes shall not exceed approximately 200 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 fiberboard box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Sheaths of like description packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class 1, style RSC. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The sheaths shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The pen and pencil sheaths covered by this specification are intended to be used as holders and pocket protectors when carrying pens, pencils, scales, slide rules, drawing instruments and similar equipment in the pocket.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Type and class (1.2).

(c) Color, when other than as specified (3.5).

(d) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(e) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein (4.1).

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable to Federal Government requirements.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.5 Transportation Description

6.5.1 Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Sheath, Leather

Rail:
Leather goods, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34,
Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:
Leather goods, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115,
National Motor Freight Classification.

Sheath, Plastic

Rail:
Plastic articles, not otherwise indexed by name. (Specify weight per cu. ft.).
Carload minimum weights 10,000, 20,000 and 30,000 pounds,
subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:
Plastic articles, not otherwise indexed. (Specify density).
Truckload minimum weights 10,000, 16,000, 21,000 and 30,000 pounds,
subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. (See last page).

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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